THE JOPETNAH FOUNDATION

Complaints and Response Mechanism

Building Whole Communities, One Life at a Time.

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Executive Summary

The Jopetnah Foundation (TJF) is committed to maintaining a culture of accountability, transparency, respect and ethical conduct.

This Complaints and Response Mechanism establishes a structured process for receiving, assessing, investigating and responding to complaints from beneficiaries, staff, partners, donors and other stakeholders.

The mechanism ensures that concerns are handled fairly, confidentially and in a timely manner while supporting continuous organizational improvement.

Purpose

The purpose of this Mechanism is to:

- Provide accessible channels for raising concerns.
- Promote accountability and transparency.
- Protect stakeholders from harm.
- Support timely resolution of complaints.
- Identify systemic issues.
- Strengthen organizational learning.
- Maintain trust with communities and partners.

Scope

This Mechanism applies to complaints relating to:

- Programme activities.
- Staff conduct.
- Partner behaviour.
- Service quality.
- Misuse of resources.
- Ethical concerns.
- Fraud or corruption concerns.
- Safeguarding issues.

- Discrimination or harassment.
- Breaches of organizational policies.

Guiding Principles

Accessibility

All stakeholders should have reasonable access to complaint channels.

Confidentiality

Information relating to complaints should be protected and shared only with authorized persons.

Fairness

Complaints should be reviewed objectively and without bias.

Respect

All complainants and respondents should be treated with dignity.

Timeliness

Complaints should be acknowledged and addressed within reasonable timelines.

Non-Retaliation

No individual should face retaliation for raising a genuine concern.

Who Can Submit a Complaint?

Complaints may be submitted by:

- Programme participants.
- Community members.
- Employees.
- Volunteers.
- Partners.
- Suppliers.
- Donors.
- Other stakeholders.

Types of Complaints

Programme Complaints

Examples:

- Poor service delivery.
- Exclusion from programmes.
- Failure to meet commitments.

Staff Conduct Complaints

Examples:

- Unprofessional behaviour.
- Misconduct.
- Abuse of authority.

Financial and Integrity Complaints

Examples:

- Fraud concerns.
- Corruption allegations.
- Misuse of organizational resources.

Safeguarding Complaints

Examples:

- Exploitation.
- Abuse.
- Harm to children or vulnerable persons.
- Sexual misconduct.

Safeguarding complaints require immediate escalation according to safeguarding procedures.

Complaint Channels

The Foundation may receive complaints through:

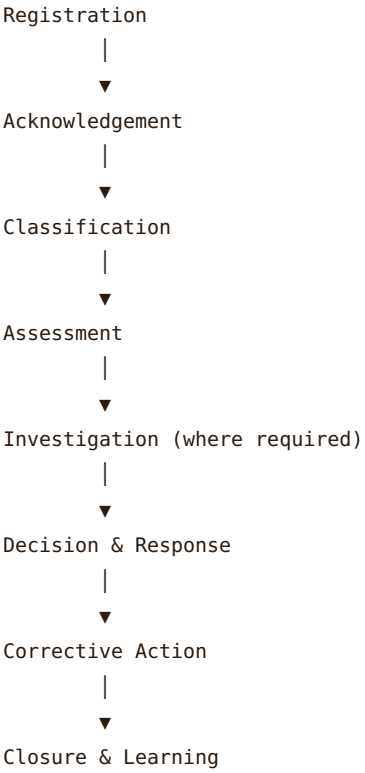
- Written submissions.
- Email channels.
- Telephone reporting.
- Website forms.
- Community meetings.
- Direct reporting to designated officers.
- Partner reporting mechanisms.

The Foundation should provide channels appropriate to local contexts.

Complaint Handling Process

The standard process is:

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Complaint Received
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Complaint Registration

Each complaint should receive:

- Unique reference number.
- Date received.
- Complaint category.
- Description.
- Location/programme area.
- Assigned responsible officer.
- Status.

Sensitive information should be handled securely.

Complaint Classification

Complaints should be classified according to:

- Severity.
- Urgency.
- Risk level.
- Required response.

Examples:

Category	Response Priority
General concern	Standard
Programme issue	Priority
Financial misconduct	High
Safeguarding concern	Immediate

Investigation Standards

Where investigation is required:

- Investigators should be appropriately assigned.
- Conflicts of interest must be avoided.
- Evidence should be documented.
- Confidentiality should be maintained.
- Findings should be objective.

Response Standards

Responses should:

- Acknowledge the complaint.
- Explain actions taken.
- Provide outcomes where appropriate.
- Maintain confidentiality.
- Communicate respectfully.

Where details cannot be disclosed, the complainant should receive an appropriate explanation.

Escalation Procedures

Complaints should be escalated when they involve:

- Serious misconduct.
- Safeguarding concerns.
- Legal issues.
- Significant financial risks.
- Senior leadership involvement.
- Repeated unresolved issues.

Roles and Responsibilities

Board of Trustees

Responsible for:

- Oversight of serious complaints.
- Ensuring organizational accountability.

Executive Director

Responsible for:

- Ensuring effective implementation.
- Reviewing significant complaints.
- Supporting corrective action.

MEAL Team

Responsible for:

- Maintaining complaint records.
- Monitoring trends.
- Reporting findings.
- Supporting accountability learning.

Safeguarding Officer

Responsible for:

- Managing safeguarding-related complaints.
- Ensuring survivor-centred approaches.
- Coordinating appropriate referrals.

Programme Teams

Responsible for:

- Promoting awareness of complaint channels.
- Supporting resolution processes.
- Implementing corrective actions.

Complaint Tracking

The Foundation should maintain a complaint register containing:

- Complaint reference.
- Date received.
- Category.
- Status.
- Responsible officer.
- Resolution date.
- Corrective actions.

Learning from Complaints

Complaint analysis should identify:

- Recurring issues.
- Programme weaknesses.
- Operational risks.
- Training needs.
- Policy improvements.

Complaints should be viewed as opportunities for strengthening organizational performance.

Protection Against Retaliation

The Foundation prohibits retaliation against individuals who:

- Submit complaints.
- Report concerns.
- Participate in investigations.
- Provide information honestly.

Any retaliation may result in disciplinary action.

Confidentiality and Data Protection

Complaint information shall:

- Be securely stored.
- Be accessible only to authorized personnel.
- Protect personal identities where required.
- Follow applicable data protection requirements.

Monitoring the Mechanism

The Foundation may track:

- Number of complaints received.
- Complaint categories.
- Resolution rates.
- Average response time.
- Repeat issues.
- Corrective actions completed.

Review

This Mechanism shall be reviewed every two years or sooner where lessons learned, organizational changes or regulatory requirements require updates.

> **A trusted organization is one that listens, responds and improves. The Jopetnah Foundation views complaints not as threats, but as opportunities to strengthen accountability, protect stakeholders and improve impact.**